



Xiaomi soap dispenser

Xiaomi has announced a wide range of new products for India under the tagline "smarter living". <http://dgit.in/oct20-29>



No OnePlus 8T Pro

OnePlus is focusing on just the OnePlus 8T with its mid-cycle refresh, so no Pro model this year. <http://dgit.in/oct20-30>

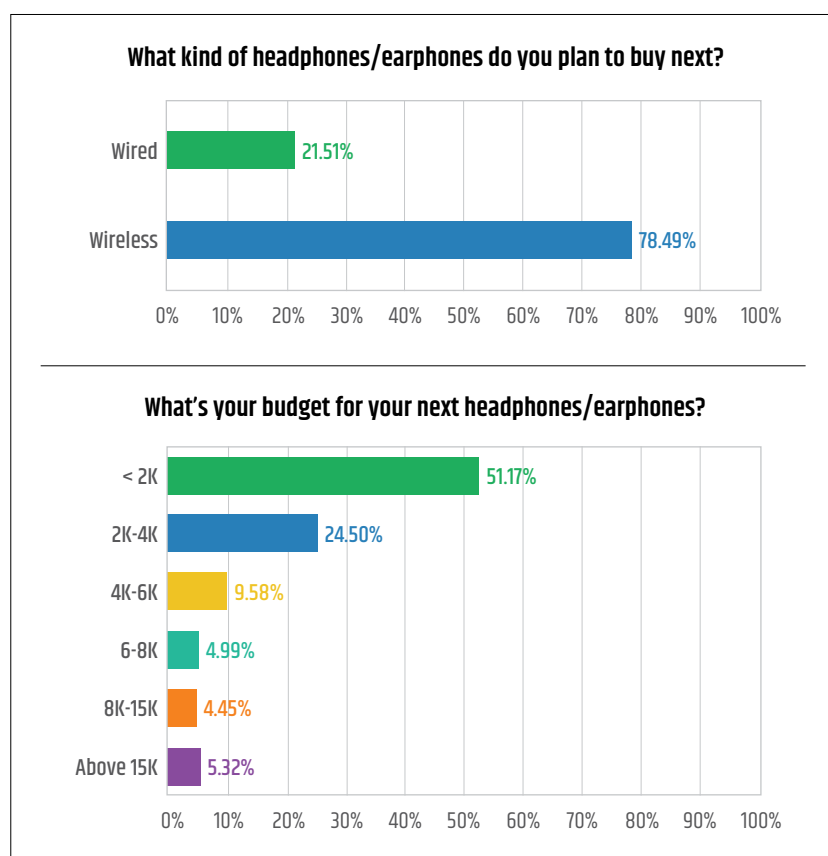
brands of headphones, followed closely by Sony in fourth and Apple in fifth. For their upcoming purchase, however, Samsung dropped to fifth position, with JBL claiming the number one spot, followed by boAt, Sony and Apple. boAt is the only 'budgetary' audio brand in the top 5 of both the 'owned' and 'to be purchased' lists, which indicates that consumers in India value quality, expected lifespan, and even sound quality over the upfront cost.

Additionally, through our survey, we also noticed that consumers are now more primed to make headphone purchases online rather than from traditional brick and mortar stores. Of course, the ongoing pandemic could be a large contributing factor to this statistic, and could have definitely skewed the results in the favour of online stores. 72 percent of our respondents stated that they would prefer buying headphones/earphones from online stores and stated discounts as the primary reason for this choice. For people who still preferred offline stores, the number one reason was that they could try the product before buying it.

THE SWEET SPOT IN PRICE RANGE

In general, India is a pretty price-conservative society. Value for money deals and discounts is usually what attracts Indian consumers into purchasing electronics, which is why we usually wait for sales such as the Big Billion Day Sale, Amazon Prime Day sale, and others to make more expensive purchases. In our survey, a whopping 41.6 percent respondents bought their current headphones/earphones at the sub-2K price point, while 28.8 percent of them are using the earphones that they got in the box with their smartphones. A meagre 3.72 percent of the respondents owned headphones above the 15K price point.

In our survey, we also saw a pretty decent shift in the price range that the respondents would make their next purchase in. The above 15K price range climbed to 5.32 percent, but more importantly, the sub-2K range saw a sizable shift, with a whopping 51.17



percent saying that their next purchase of headphones would be under ₹2,000. This is mainly due to the fact that brands such as Xiaomi, Realme, Zebronics, pTron, and others are offering sub-2K audio products with a decent set of features as well. There are even multiple true wireless in-ears that are being offered at this price range, which is a massive shift from 2016-2017, when only the premium, high-end brands had truly captured this segment. There are sub-2K products that offer voice assistant support, a sizable battery life, an IP rating, and sometimes, even touch controls! The price conscious Indian market really has very few reasons to move away from the lowest possible price since brands are constantly working towards packing value at this price range.

Nevertheless, more exorbitant purchases in the headphone market are definitely becoming more common than before. For instance, in 2019, Sennheiser, a premium headphone brand, registered a whopping 200-300

percent growth in wireless headphones sales. Additionally, with features such as ANC, Ambient Sound, and others introduced in headphones and earphones, consumers from business backgrounds began investing in premium headphones to utilise these features during flights, daily commute, or even to focus in the office. However, it is apparent that companies that dabble in premium headphones and earphones are now having to offer a set of features that set them apart completely from their budgetary rivals.

Overall, the Indian headphone market is definitely moving towards wireless freedom, especially as even the last few phones that sport 3.5mm audio jacks have also begun ditching them. Additionally, the Indian market is showing some signs of consumers being more open to purchase the more premium audio products, however, budgetary headphones and earphones still reign supreme, especially as they continue to expand on features, thereby providing excellent value for money. 